

Exercise 1 :

Consider the state space from Figure 1.

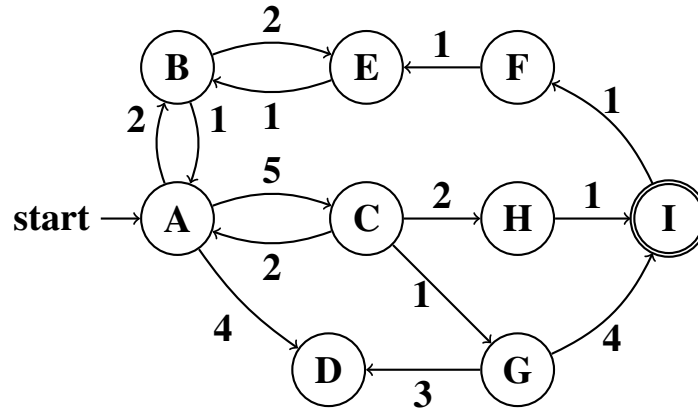


Figure 1: State space.

As a heuristic estimate for a state s , use the minimal number of edges that are needed to reach a goal state from s (or ∞ if s is not solvable, e.g., $h(C) = 2$).

As tie-breaking criteria, if the choice of the next state to be expanded is not unique, expand the lexicographically smallest state first (so A would be expanded before B if both have the same f -value).

- (i) Run Uniform-cost-search on this problem. Draw the search graph and **annotate each node with the g value as well as the order of expansion**. Draw duplicate nodes as well, and mark them accordingly by crossing them out. Give the solution found. Is this solution optimal? Justify your answer.
- (ii) Run A^* search on this problem. Draw the search graph and **annotate each node with the g and h value as well as the order of expansion**. Draw duplicate nodes as well, and mark them accordingly by crossing them out. Give the solution found by A^* search. Is this solution optimal? Justify your answer.
- (iii) What is the minimum number of states that must be expanded by uniform-cost-search regardless of tie-breaking?
- (iv) What is the lower bound on the minimum number of states that must be expanded by A^* search regardless of tie-breaking (ignoring all states with f equal to the optimal solution cost).
- (v) In terms of runtime, which algorithm will find the optimal solution faster. Justify your answer.

Solution:

- (i) The solution is A, C, H, I . Uniform-cost search is guaranteed to return an optimal solution if there are no negative costs.

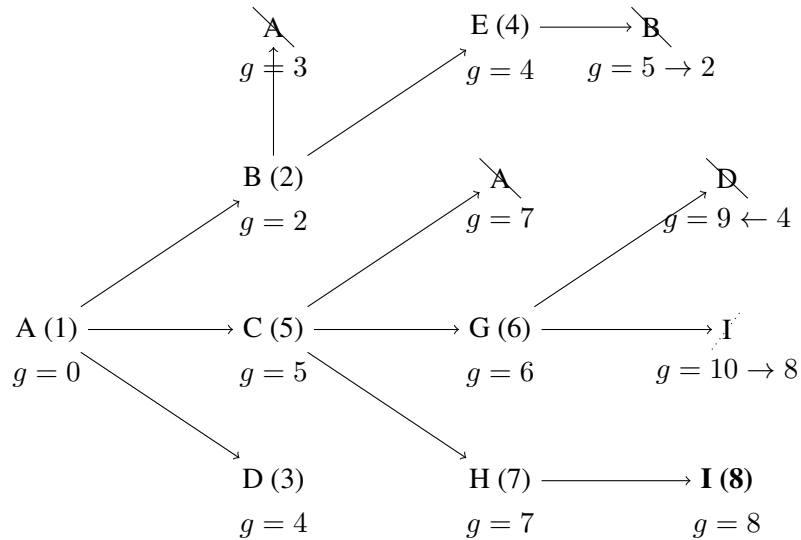


Figure 2: Solution to part (i). The algorithm stops when the goal node I is selected for expansion.

- (ii) The solution is A, C, H, I . A^* is guaranteed to return an optimal solution if the heuristic that is being used is consistent. Thus, it remains to show that the described heuristic h is consistent, i.e., that for every transition $s \xrightarrow{a} s'$, it holds that $h(s) - h(s') \leq c(a)$. By definition of our heuristic the following holds: $\forall s, s' \in S \setminus \{D\} : s \xrightarrow{a} s' \implies |h(s) - h(s')| = 1$. That means that the difference in heuristic values between any state s and any successor state s' of s is maximally 1, except for state D . In the special case of state D being the successor state, $h(s) - h(s') = -\infty$, which is less than the cost of any action (since D is a dead end it does not have any successors). Otherwise the minimal cost for any transaction is 1, so the heuristic is consistent.

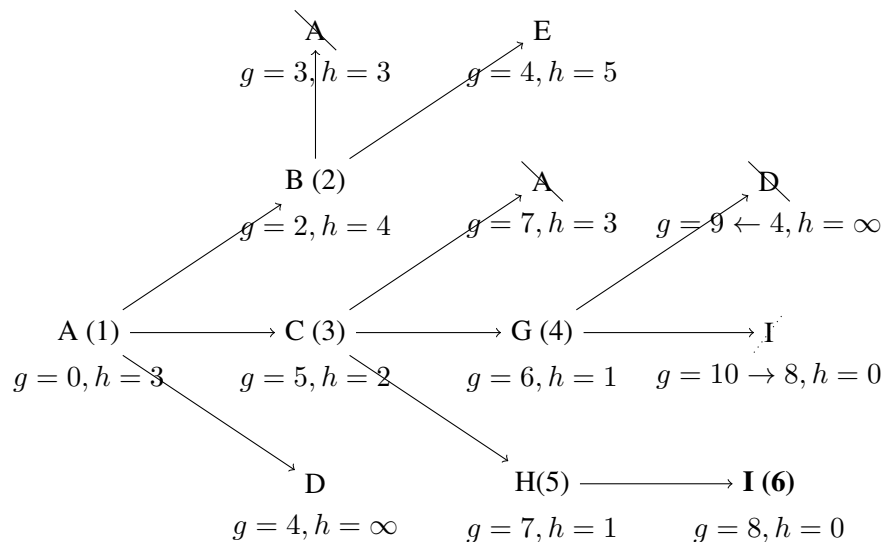


Figure 3: Solution to part (ii). The algorithm stops when the goal node I is selected for expansion.

- (iii) Uniform-cost search will explore all states with a g -value lower than the cost of the optimal solution. In this example, the optimal solution cost is 8 and there are 7 states with an optimal g -value lower than 8.
- (iv) A* search (and any other algorithm that guarantees the optimal solution and does not have access to any additional source of information) will explore all states with an f -value lower than the cost of the optimal solution. In this example, the optimal solution cost is 8 and there are 4 states with an optimal f -value lower than 8. Note that in this case to find a solution H must also be expanded, so that's why the question asks for the lower-bound ignoring those states with an f -value equal to the optimal solution (as it is difficult in the general case to know whose of those must be expanded necessarily).
- (v) It depends. A* expands fewer states, but it requires computing the heuristic per state. So which algorithm is faster depends on the runtime of expanding a state and generating the successors and the runtime of computing the heuristic. Also, if the heuristic is inconsistent, A* may expand nodes with the same state more than once.

Exercise 2 :

Formalize the following problems as state-space problems: define a suitable state space, a start state, set of actions, the action function, and a goal test.

- a. In the movie *Die hard: With a vengeance*, Bruce Willis and Samuel L. Jackson are given a water jug riddle, which they need to solve in order to disarm a bomb: There is a water fountain and two jugs that can hold 3 and 5 liters of water, respectively. How do you measure up 4 liters of water (to disarm the bomb) using only the two jugs?
- b. (From Russel & Norvig, Exercise 3.9): The *missionaries and cannibals problem* is usually stated as follows: Three missionaries and three cannibals are on one side of a river, along with a boat that can hold either one or two people. Find a way to get everyone to the other side of the river without ever leaving a group of missionaries in one place outnumbered by the cannibals in that place.

Note: This exercise is for you to reflect in the problem definition. Do not spend too much time “formalizing” the problem if you find it difficult, just provide an intuition of how these problems can be encoded as state space search problems.

Solution:

- a. States are the possible filling amounts (in full liters) of the two jugs. For example, $(2, 0)$ is the state corresponding to the case where the first jug contains 2 liters and the second jug contains 0 liters. The start state is $(0, 0)$. The 'fill second jug' action leads to the state $(0, 5)$ from which the state $(3, 2)$ can be reached by the action 'fill first jug from second jug'. A goal state is any state where the second jug contains 4 liters.

To formalize the actions and transition relation, consider the set of actions to be fill-x, fill-y (representing filling each of the two jars), empty-x, empty-y (representing emptying each of

the two jars), and transfer-x, transfer-y (representing pouring one jar into the other). Then, the transition relation is: $T = T_{fillx} \cup T_{filly} \cup T_{emptyx} \cup T_{emptyy} \cup T_{transferx} \cup T_{transfery}$, where:

- $T_{fillx} = \{((x, y), \text{fill-x}, (3, y)) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$
- $T_{filly} = \{((x, y), \text{fill-y}, (x, 5)) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$
- $T_{emptyx} = \{((x, y), \text{empty-x}, (0, y)) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$
- $T_{emptyy} = \{((x, y), \text{empty-y}, (x, 0)) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$
- $T_{transferx} = \{((x, y), \text{transfer-x}, (\max(0, 5-(x+y)), \min(x+y, 5))) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$
- $T_{transfery} = \{((x, y), \text{transfer-y}, (\min(x+y, 3), \max(0, 3-(x+y)))) \text{ for all } x \in [0, 3], y \in [0, 5]\}$

- b. Here is one possible representation: A state is a six-tuple of integers listing the number of missionaries, cannibals, and boats on the first side, and then the second side of the river. The goal is a state with 3 missionaries and 3 cannibals on the second side. The cost function is one per action, and the successors of a state are all the states that move 1 or 2 people and 1 boat from one side to another.

Exercise 3 :

Consider a variant of the Vacuum Cleaner problem from the lecture where a robot has to clean a 3×3 square room (see Figure 4). There are four possible actions: up, left, right, and down. There is no suck action since the robot automatically cleans any dirty spot it stands on. Hence, its task is moving around the room and visit all dirty spots. Throughout the exercise, we use Manhattan distance.

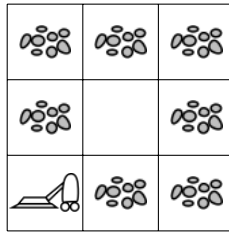


Figure 4: Illustration of the Vacuum Cleaner problem

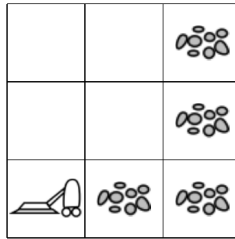
Which of the following heuristics are admissible? Why / Why not? Give clear proof arguments. (Formal proofs are not needed.)

- (i) h_1 = Number of dirty spots.
- (ii) h_2 = Number of clean spots.
- (iii) h_3 = Sum of the distances from the robot to all the dirty spots.
- (iv) $h_4 = h_1 + h_2$.
- (v) h_5 = Minimum distance from the robot to any dirty spot.

Note: To prove a heuristic admissible, you need to show that it is admissible for every state of the illustrated 3×3 example. To show that a heuristic is not admissible, a counter example is sufficient.

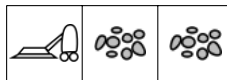
Solution:

- (i) h_1 : Admissible, because to clean one dirty spot it takes at least one action and one action can clean at most one spot. the robot needs to reach at least one dirty spot.
- (ii) h_2 : Not admissible (Not even a heuristic, since $h_2(G) \neq 0$). Consider the following counter example:



Here, $h_2 = 5$, while $h^* = 4$, which makes it not admissible.

- (iii) h_3 : Not admissible. Consider the following counterexample, where $h_3 = 1 + 2 = 3 > 2 = h^*$ (assume that the rest of the board has already been cleaned):



- (iv) h_4 : Not admissible. Consider again the counter example from h_3 . It is $h_5 = h_1 + h_2 = 2 + 1 = 3$, but $h^* = 2$. (Since it incorporates h_2 which is not a heuristic, the combination is also not admissible).
- (v) h_5 : Admissible, because the robot needs to reach at least one dirty spot.

Exercise 4 :

Consider a robot that can move in the grid below. The cost of moving from one cell to another is equal to the number of steps required for the move, where by a single step the robot can move horizontally or vertically to an adjacent cell (no diagonal steps allowed).

				S			
		X_1				X_5	
	X_2				X_4		
			X_3				

The cells marked X_1 , X_2 , X_3 , X_4 , and X_5 are *cells of interest*, each holding one or two of the symbols a , b , and c :

- X_1 : (a, c)
- X_2 : (b)
- X_3 : (b, c)
- X_4 : (c)
- X_5 : (a)

That is, X_1 holds the symbols a and c . When visiting a cell the robot collects the symbols located at that cell.

Starting in cell S , the robot's task is to visit cells of interest and collect exactly one copy of each of the three symbols (a, b, c) before returning to cell S . The robot is *not* allowed to move to a cell containing, e.g., an a if the robot has previously visited a cell holding an a .

Determine which of the cells of interest to visit and in which order these cells should be visited by the robot, so that the cost of the path traveled (when starting and ending in cell S) is minimized.

1. Define a suitable state and action representation for this problem.
2. Define a heuristic function that at any given state provides an underestimate of the cost of reaching a goal state (i.e., a state where the robot is located in cell S with the symbols (a, b, c)).
3. Show the search tree for this problem as it would be expanded using A* search.

Solution:

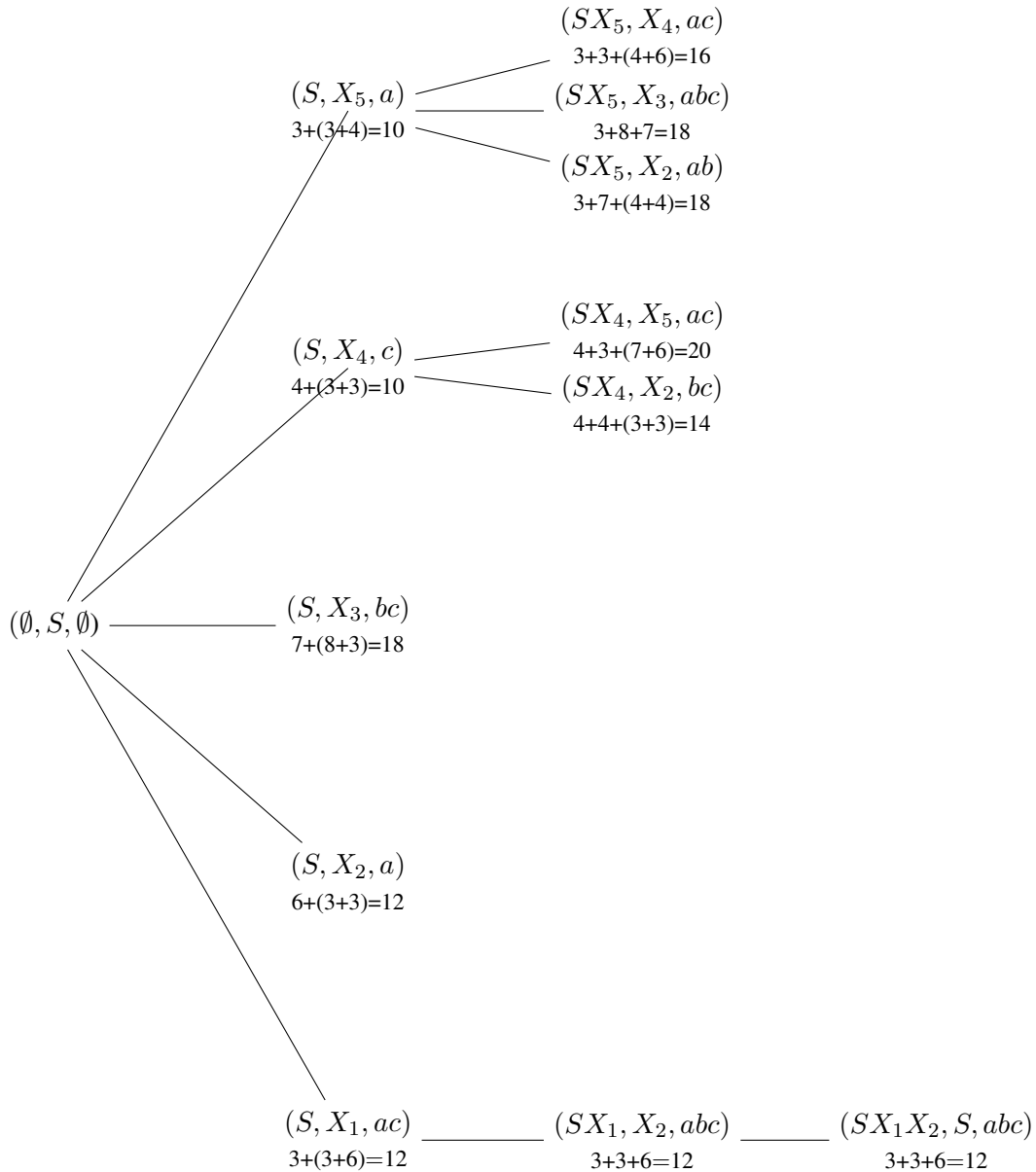
Sub-problem 1

One possible state representation could be $(cell\ history, current\ cell, symbols\ collected)$, where we keep track of the cells previously visited, the current cell the robot is in, and which symbols that have been collected so far. We can, however, also do without including the cell history in the state representation.

Sub-problem 2

One possible heuristic function could be the minimal cost incurred by visiting an admissible cell holding a symbol not yet collected and afterwards returning to S .

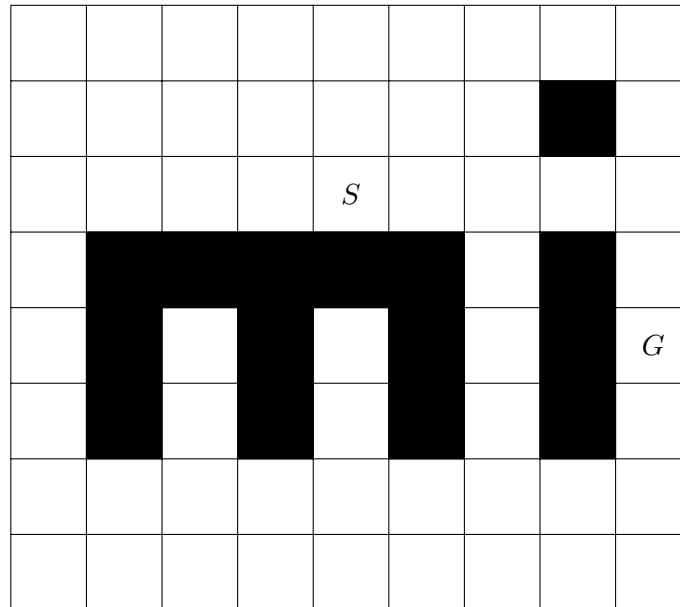
Sub-problem 3



Exercise 5 :

Consider the problem of finding a path from position S to G in the grid shown below. You can only move horizontally and vertically and only one step at a time; no step can be made into the shaded areas or outside

the grid. The cost of the path between two positions is the number of steps on the path.



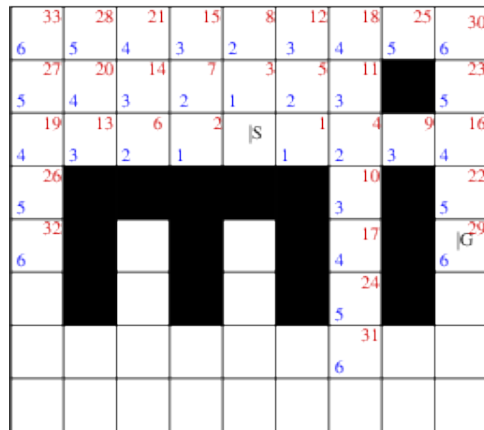
1. Number the positions (cells in the grid) in the order in which they are added to the frontier in a uniform-cost search for G starting at S . Assume that the ordering of the operators is *right*, *down*, *left*, and *up*, and that there is multiple path pruning. When multiple lowest-cost paths exists, choose the path first added to the frontier.
2. Define a heuristic function that underestimates the cost of the lowest-cost path.
3. Number the positions (cells in the grid) in the order in which they are added to the frontier according to an A^* search using your heuristic function. Resolve ambiguities using the operator ordering and the procedure above.

NB: When numbering the positions it may be helpful to also annotate the positions with the cost/function values calculated during the search.

Solution:

Answer 1

The red numbers specify the order in which the cells are added to the frontier. The blue numbers are the costs associated with the cells.



Answer 2

One possible heuristic function simply calculates the cost of the lowest-cost path ignoring the obstacles (shaded regions).

Answer 3

